

D663

The Professional Educator

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A popular eighth-grade teacher who coaches the debate team receives a friend request on her personal social media account from a current student. The student is a strong debater and just won a regional trophy. What is the most professional response?

- A. Decline the request and use school-approved channels for any communication with the student.
- B. Accept it but keep messages private.
- C. Accept friend requests from all students so it is fair.
- D. Accept it to build rapport, since the student is a high achiever.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher needs to remind a student about a missing assignment during the evening. Which method keeps appropriate boundaries?

- A. No contact is ever allowed outside school hours.
- B. Send a message through the school's learning platform, visible to the family.
- C. Text the student from a personal phone.
- D. Direct message the student on social media.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A quiet fourth grader who loves the class library tells her teacher that an adult at home hits her with a belt. She has several bruises on her arms. The teacher has a planning period next and a staff meeting after school. What should the teacher do?

- A. Call the family to ask what happened.
- B. Wait until after the staff meeting to talk it over with colleagues.
- C. Gather more evidence by questioning the student in detail first.
- D. Report promptly to the designated authority according to state law and school policy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher reported suspected neglect. Later, the agency found no abuse. What does this outcome mean for the teacher?

- A.** The teacher should now investigate on her own.
- B.** The teacher should have waited for proof.
- C.** The teacher acted correctly; reports made in good faith are generally protected.
- D.** The teacher will lose her license.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

At a school carnival, a parent who volunteers every week asks a teacher how another child in the class did on the state test. The carnival raised money for new playground equipment. What should the teacher do?

- A.** Share it, since test scores are public information.
- B.** Politely decline to share any information about another student.
- C.** Share the score only if the parent promises to keep it private.
- D.** Share general results since the parent volunteers often.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Who is most likely allowed to see a student's IEP without additional consent?

- A.** The student's general education teacher who implements the IEP.
- B.** A parent volunteer who helps in the classroom.
- C.** Anyone at the school, since records are shared.
- D.** A teacher at the school who has never taught the student.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A teacher's lesson on main idea did not go well: only 9 of 26 exit tickets were correct. The class had an assembly earlier, and it was raining. Which reflection is most useful?

- A.** The students were distracted by the assembly and rain, so no change is needed.
- B.** The lesson felt rushed, so I will feel calmer next time.
- C.** These students cannot learn main idea.
- D.** Sort the exit tickets for common errors and plan a change in modeling for tomorrow.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A teacher's data show that students' written explanations in science are weak. Her school offers free workshops on many topics, and she enjoys the workshop on classroom décor. Which professional growth goal is best?

- A. Attend the classroom décor workshop.
- B. By spring, use a claim-evidence-reasoning routine weekly and raise the share of students scoring proficient on explanations from 40% to 65%.
- C. Become a better science teacher.
- D. Complete 20 hours of any professional development.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A grade-level PLC meets every Wednesday in the library, and the team brings coffee and snacks. They just gave a common math assessment. Which agenda best uses PLC time?

- A. Read school announcements and discuss upcoming events.
- B. Plan the snack schedule for the year.
- C. Review the common assessment results, find which skills students missed, and plan re-teaching and extension groups.
- D. Share complaints about the new curriculum.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A PLC notices that one teacher's students scored much higher on a common assessment. What is the most productive next step?

- A. Stop giving common assessments.
- B. Assume the test was easier for that class.
- C. Ask that teacher to share the strategies used so the team can try them.
- D. Rank teachers by score for the principal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

During a state reading test, a teacher sees a student has marked an answer the teacher knows is wrong. The school's scores dropped last year, and the principal wants improvement. What should the teacher do?

- A.** Follow the testing rules and give no hints or signals.
- B.** Help only students who are close to passing.
- C.** Help this once, because the principal wants higher scores.
- D.** Tap the wrong answer so the student rethinks it.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A teacher plans to give only simple worksheets to students who are learning English, assuming they cannot handle grade-level texts. The class has 29 students and a strong reading culture. What is the better approach?

- A.** Reduce the class size before changing anything.
- B.** Keep the simple worksheets to avoid frustration.
- C.** Give them the same texts with no support.
- D.** Provide grade-level texts with supports such as visuals, vocabulary previews, and partner talk.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A popular eighth-grade teacher ~~who coaches the debate team~~ receives a friend request on her personal social media account from a current student. ~~The student is a strong debater and just won a regional trophy.~~ What is the most professional response?

Target word: professional boundaries **Decides:** Personal account, current student.

A	Correct	Keeps communication professional and transparent.
B	Inverted operation	Private messaging is the risk, not a safeguard.
C	Absolute language	Fairness does not justify crossing the boundary with everyone.
D	Camouflage	Achievement does not change the boundary.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher needs to remind a student about a missing assignment during the evening. Which method keeps appropriate boundaries?

Target word: reverse: choose the appropriate channel **Decides:** Transparent, school-approved communication.

A	Absolute language	Approved channels may be used after hours.
B	Correct	School channel with transparency.
C	Inverted operation	Private personal channel.
D	Adjacent category	Personal platform outside school oversight.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A quiet fourth grader ~~who loves the class library~~ tells her teacher that an adult at home hits her with a belt. She has several bruises on her arms. ~~The teacher has a planning period next and a staff meeting after school.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: mandatory reporting duty **Decides:** Disclosure creates reasonable suspicion.

A	Inverted operation	Can put the child at greater risk.
B	Camouflage	The schedule does not delay the duty to report.
C	Adjacent category	Investigation is the job of trained authorities.
D	Correct	Reasonable suspicion triggers a duty to report; the teacher does not need proof.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A teacher reported suspected neglect. Later, the agency found no abuse. What does this outcome mean for the teacher?

Target word: reverse: after a good-faith report **Decides:** The duty is based on reasonable suspicion, not proof.

A	Adjacent category	Investigation belongs to the agency.
B	Inverted operation	Waiting for proof is not what the law requires.
C	Correct	Reasonable suspicion was the standard, not certainty.
D	Absolute language	Good-faith reports are typically protected.

5. Answer B Concept 3

At a school carnival, a parent ~~who volunteers every week~~ asks a teacher how another child in the class did on the state test. ~~The carnival raised money for new playground equipment.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: confidentiality **Decides:** The parent has no legitimate educational interest in another child's record.

A	Confusion set	Individual scores are protected education records.
B	Correct	FERPA protects the other child's records.
C	Adjacent category	A promise does not create a right to access.
D	Camouflage	Volunteering does not grant access to records.

6. Answer A Concept 3 · transfer

Who is most likely allowed to see a student's IEP without additional consent?

Target word: reverse: who has legitimate educational interest **Decides:** A school official who works with the student.

A	Correct	Has a legitimate educational interest.
B	Adjacent category	Volunteers do not have record access by default.
C	Absolute language	Access is limited to legitimate interest.
D	Dropped element	Working at the school is not enough; there must be an educational need.

7. Answer D Concept 4

A teacher's lesson on main idea did not go well: only 9 of 26 exit tickets were correct. ~~The class had an assembly earlier, and it was raining.~~ Which reflection is most useful?

Target word: evidence-based reflection **Decides:** Uses student evidence to plan a change.

A	Camouflage	Blames outside factors and ignores the evidence.
B	Dropped element	Focuses on feelings without student evidence.
C	Absolute language	Blames students instead of examining practice.
D	Correct	Evidence drives the next instructional decision.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A teacher's data show that students' written explanations in science are weak. Her school offers free workshops on many topics, ~~and she enjoys the workshop on classroom décor.~~ Which professional growth goal is best?

Target word: data-driven, measurable PD goal **Decides:** Goal must tie to the identified need and be measurable.

A	Camouflage	Enjoyable but unrelated to the need.
B	Correct	Specific, measurable, and tied to the need.
C	Adjacent category	Vague and not measurable.
D	Dropped element	Hours without a goal tied to the need.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A grade-level PLC ~~meets every Wednesday in the library, and the team brings coffee and snacks.~~ They just gave a common math assessment. Which agenda best uses PLC time?

Target word: PLC focus **Decides:** Shared data on student learning and response.

A	Adjacent category	Operational business, not the PLC's purpose.
B	Camouflage	Reacts to the snacks detail.
C	Correct	Focuses on learning, evidence, and response.
D	Dropped element	Drops the focus on student learning data.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A PLC notices that one teacher's students scored much higher on a common assessment. What is the most productive next step?

Target word: reverse: using data to share practice **Decides:** PLCs learn from what works.

A	Inverted operation	Removes the data that allow learning from each other.
B	Confusion set	Dismisses the evidence without checking.
C	Correct	Collaborative learning from evidence.
D	Adjacent category	Evaluation is not the PLC's purpose.

11. Answer A Concept 7

During a state reading test, a teacher sees a student has marked an answer the teacher knows is wrong. ~~The school's scores dropped last year, and the principal wants improvement.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: test integrity **Decides:** Test security rules prohibit hints.

A	Correct	Test security and honest data come first.
B	Adjacent category	Still a violation, just targeted.
C	Camouflage	Pressure does not change the ethical duty.
D	Inverted operation	Any cue is a security violation.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A teacher plans to give only simple worksheets to students who are learning English, assuming they cannot handle grade-level texts. ~~The class has 29 students and a strong reading culture.~~ What is the better approach?

Target word: high expectations with support **Decides:** Keep grade-level goals and add language support.

A	Camouflage	Class size is not the issue.
B	Inverted operation	Lowers expectations based on language status.
C	Dropped element	Drops the scaffolds needed for access.
D	Correct	High expectations plus scaffolds.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Professional boundaries	Keep communication with students professional, transparent, and on school-approved channels.	Private social media friendships or one-on-one texting framed as building rapport.	A student reaching out on a personal account or phone.
2	Mandatory reporting	An educator who has reasonable suspicion of abuse or neglect must report it promptly to the designated authority; proof is not required and the educator does not investigate.	Waiting to gather proof, or relying on someone else to report.	A disclosure or signs of possible abuse.
3	Confidentiality of student records	Share student information only with those who have a legitimate educational interest; FERPA protects education records.	Discussing a student's scores or needs with other parents or in public spaces.	Someone asks about another student's information.
4	Reflective practice	Effective reflection uses evidence of student learning to identify what to change next time.	Reflecting only on feelings or blaming students without looking at evidence.	A lesson that did not go as planned.
5	Goal-driven professional learning	Professional growth goals are specific, measurable, and tied to a need shown in student or practice data.	Choosing workshops by convenience or collecting hours without a goal.	Planning professional development.
6	Professional learning communities	PLCs focus on what students should learn, how we know they learned it, and how to respond when they have not—using shared data.	Using PLC time for announcements or complaints.	A team meeting agenda.
7	Integrity in assessment and records	Educators follow test security and report grades and data honestly, even when results are disappointing.	Coaching answers during a standardized test or adjusting data to look better.	Pressure around test scores.
8	High expectations and fairness for all	Hold every student to high expectations with support, and check decisions for bias.	Lowering expectations for students based on background or label.	Assumptions about what certain students can do.

Course scope (public description): The Professional Educator prepares WGU students to excel in the exciting and impactful profession of being an educator. Additionally, the course addresses the importance of continuous professional development and ethical considerations in teaching through the School of Education (SOE) Professional Dispositions and Ethics. Upon completion of the course, WGU students will be equipped with the tools and insights needed to continue their professional journey of becoming effective, inspiring, and adaptive educators, capable of making a significant impact in the lives of their students and the broader educational community. (This is not a transferable course.)